Umur Cengiz

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Research fields: market microstructure, fixed income and repo markets, funding and market liquidity, central bank asset purchases, high-frequency financial data.

Education

PhD in Business Economics, Finance, KU Leuven & IÉSEG School of Management 2021 to present
Dissertation: *Essays on the Microstructure of the Collateral Market*. Supervisors: Renaud Beaupain (IÉSEG) and Gunther Wuyts (KU Leuven). Expected defence: January or February 2027.

MSc Finance and Investment, University of Nottingham, United Kingdom 2019 to 2020
Full scholarship. Distinction, 84 of 100. Best Master's Thesis Award.

BSc Business Administration, Galatasaray University, Istanbul, Turkey 2012 to 2017
High honours, GPA 3.60 of 4.00.

Job Market Paper

Special in Repo, Thin on the Ask sole-authored
Documents how the two sides of the interdealer cash order book of Italian government bonds vary with repo specialness, using the best quotes, the full order book rebuilt from quote records, and executed orders. With bond and day fixed effects, a bond with 2 basis points of specialness has about 8 log points less depth at the best ask than a bond at the general collateral rate, while its quoted bid–ask spread does not differ. Over longer horizons, special bonds also have more depth at the best bid and fewer executed sells relative to buys. In a model of dealer quotes, a cost of sourcing a bond that is hard to borrow raises dealers' reservation prices, and with discrete prices dealers withdraw from the best ask and join the best bid.

Working Papers

Liquidity Push, Collateral Rush with Renaud Beaupain and Gunther Wuyts
Semi-finalist, Best Paper Award in Market Microstructure, FMA Annual Meeting 2026.
Studies the cash and special-repo markets for Italian government bonds around the ECB's Pandemic Emergency Purchase Programme. During the programme, quoted bid–ask spreads narrow by more than a third and top-of-the-book depth rises by about two-thirds, while specialness rises by about 70%. Intraday vector autoregressions show that cash-market shocks travel increasingly through depth.

Liquidity Spirals and Repo Specialness with Renaud Beaupain and Gunther Wuyts
Doctoral Consortium Award, Southwestern Finance Association, 2026.
Studies how secured funding conditions, measured in the general collateral repo market, and the liquidity of the Italian cash and repo markets move together across floor, elevated and stress funding regimes, using state-dependent local projections.

Conferences

2026: FMA Annual Meeting (Tampa), EFMA Annual Meeting (Kristiansand), SWFA Annual Meeting and Doctoral Consortium (Dallas)
2025: FMA European Conference (Limassol), AFFI Annual Conference (Dijon)
2024: FEBS MENA-Asian Conference (Sharjah), Financial Economics Meeting (Paris)

Discussant: FMA Annual Meeting 2026, EFMA Annual Meeting 2026, AFFI Annual Conference 2025, FEBS MENA-Asian Conference 2024, Financial Economics Meeting 2024
Session chair: Financial Economics Meeting 2024

Awards and Honours

Best Paper Award Semi-finalist, Market Microstructure Financial Management Association, 2026
Doctoral Consortium Award Southwestern Finance Association, 2026
Best Master's Thesis Award University of Nottingham, 2020
Full MSc Scholarship University of Nottingham, 2019 to 2020

Teaching

IÉSEG School of Management. Average student rating of the instructor 4.3 of 5 (344 responses, 22 class groups).

Portfolio Management (Master's)	2025/26
Financial Instruments and Technology (Bachelor's, 12 class groups)	2022/23 to 2024/25
International Finance (Bachelor's)	2022/23 to 2024/25
Quantitative Methods for Economics and Finance (Bachelor's)	2025/26
Data Handling (Bachelor's, Python, designed the course material)	2025/26
Master's thesis supervision in empirical finance	

Other Professional Experience

Financial Analyst, Japan Tobacco International, Turkey	2018 to 2019
Consultant, PricewaterhouseCoopers, Turkey	2017 to 2018

Skills and Languages

Programming	Python (pandas, numpy, statsmodels, scipy), R, SQL, Stata, MATLAB, Julia, LaTeX, Git
Methods	Vector autoregressions, local projections, regime-switching models, panel methods with high-dimensional fixed effects, limit-order-book reconstruction from quote records
Languages	Turkish (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate), Spanish (beginner)

References

Renaud Beaupain (supervisor)
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Gunther Wuyts (supervisor)
KU Leuven
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